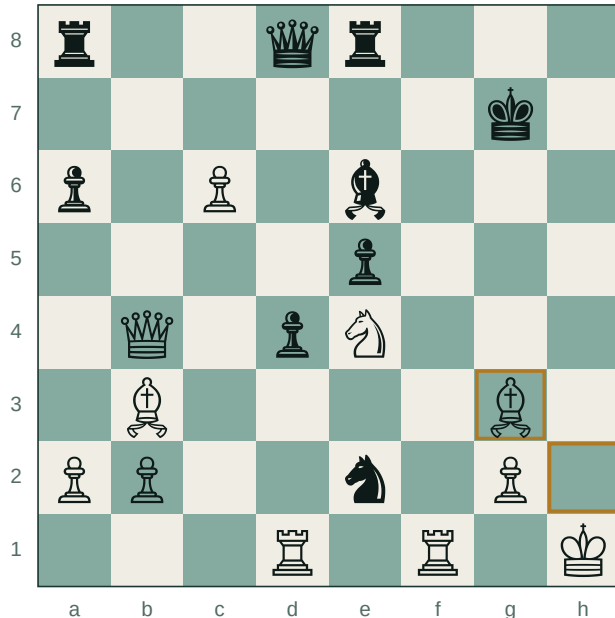


Anastasia mating nets: Black, move 31

Anastasia mating nets

Black to move



Previous move: 31.Bxg3. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

31...Rh8+ 32. Bh2 Rxxh2+ 33. Kxxh2 Qh4#

31...Rh8+ Check restricts White to 2 legal replies here. Recorded reply: **32.Bh2**.

32...Rxxh2+ Check restricts White to 1 legal reply here. The move also takes the bishop on h2. Recorded reply: **33.Kxxh2**.

33...Qh4# Mate: queen on h4 gives check; White has no legal reply.

The line ends in checkmate against the king on h2. Material gain is unnecessary once no legal defense exists.

CHECKPOINT

Which piece delivers the final check, and why can the defender not continue? **Answer:** Queen on h4. The king is in check and the position has zero legal replies.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

The knight is often a supporting piece rather than the final checker. Do not overlook its quiet control of escape squares.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

An Anastasia-type net uses a knight to restrict king escapes while a rook or queen checks along an edge file. Removing a pawn shield can be the crucial preparation.

HOW TO LOOK

Locate the knight's controlled flight squares and the heavy piece's checking line. Follow how the combination opens that line.

The defending king is on h1. Geometrically undefended: knight on e4 and queen on b4. Check for tactical protection.